
THE RECONCILIATION TAX CHECKLIST

Audit your donor, partner, and programme data before it costs you — a working checklist, not a theory. Go through each section with your actual data open.

1. Data Source Inventory

- ☐ List every place donor, partner, or programme data currently lives — including spreadsheets, shared drives, and paper logs, not just the “main” system.
- ☐ For each source, note who owns it and how often it's updated.
- ☐ Flag any source with no clear owner — these are the ones most likely to drift out of sync.

2. Field Consistency

- ☐ Compare field names for the same data across sources (e.g. “Region” vs “State” vs “Branch”).
- ☐ Check date formats match across every source (DD/MM/YYYY vs MM/DD/YYYY is a common silent break).
- ☐ Check currency fields specify a currency, not just a number.
- ☐ Confirm required fields (donor name, ID, reporting period) are actually mandatory at entry, not optional.

3. Duplicate Risk

- ☐ Search for the same donor or partner entered under slightly different names across sources.
- ☐ Check whether your system has duplicate/matching rules configured on key identifying fields.
- ☐ Confirm there's a defined process for merging duplicates once found — not just flagging them.

4. Access & Security

- ☐ Confirm sensitive records (case data, health information, protection files) are restricted to people who need them.
- ☐ Check whether any sensitive data is currently moving through email attachments or messaging apps.
- ☐ Confirm field-level permissions match your organization's actual confidentiality requirements.

5. Reporting Readiness

- ☐ Time how long it currently takes to produce one consolidated, donor-ready number.

- ☐ Identify every manual step required to get from raw data to a reportable figure.
- ☐ Confirm dashboards or report types exist that a non-technical team member could pull without help.
- ☐ Note the last time a “final” number had to be revised after being shared — and why.

If more than a few boxes above stay unchecked, the gap is usually structural, not a training issue — worth a proper CRM architecture conversation before the next reporting cycle.

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